

OREGON CITY COURIER

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FALSE HOPES

If you have traveled about in Oregon very much you have, no doubt, noticed, far from the centers of population, even, sometimes, within those very centers, an unpainted, dilapidated shack where some unfortunate had pictured the accomplishment of the dream of years. He had visioned a pretty farm, the payment to him for a life of labor and hope; he had taken land somewhere and started to live the life of a sovereign. But soon his beautiful bubble burst in the high winds of adversity. He discovered that his labors had only started and that the depression of poverty and affliction were elements unsurmountable under the difficulties which he must combat.

In Clackamas county there are several such monuments to the false hope of man. One dreary spot, set on the bank of a beautiful stream, is particularly vivid in our mind. Here a number of "shake" buildings were constructed years ago by a group of settlers who saw, in the glory of their fair dreams, the upbuilding of a prosperous farming community. They considered little the lack of wealth, and with the gold that God had endowed them in furnishing sturdy muscles and strong hearts, they commenced upon the task of building the village of hope.

The years glide swiftly, while huge roots, rocks and towering trees respond slowly to the muscle power of man. "Shake" shacks rose on the clearing that had been made. There were little houses and smaller barns, and to give the settlement a real homelike and businesslike air the good settlers whittled from a slab a crude sign bearing the simple explanation, "store." When the snow was off the ground, and walking possible, a few provisions were carried many miles to equip the settlement store, which was to feed with delicacies the mouths of a half-dozen hardy souls, who braved Nature's threats and warnings in the false hope of realizing their dreams.

The struggle was too great. Sickness and adversity took many of the little group to the only true realization of the dreams of man, and in the face of most abject poverty and privation the few remaining in this tiny mountain settlement packed their sacks and returned whence they had come. Today a group of unpainted "shake" shacks, a tumble-down roof with a whittled sign reading "store," clinging bravely to its front, are the monument to the false hopes of the patriots who dreamed dreams too beautiful.

There are no end of such places in this and other states. The fight is unequal, the odds being all against human habitation, though the soil is the most productive and the surroundings the most beautiful that were created with the world. Civilization had not then extended its roads into such places, its markets were too distant to provide food for hungry mouths and cheer for tired hearts. In a veritable forest primeval there was not food for the lean animals that came with the settlers, and invariably the last chapter of the stories of these lives was written with the one word—defeat.

The great lessons that are offered by the exhibit of these false hopes does not deter others from hoping falsely. One hundred and fifty-nine men and women, the majority of them from the marts of toil that pay but meagerly for the labor of a life, responded to the beautiful pictures painted by the Northwestern Association of Oregon City, composed of a group of swindlers who have done more to put Oregon City on the black list than any other person or thing that has ever visited its sins upon us.

How truly were this company's development schemes a memory of the days of false hopes? How truly were the hopes of those who took the bait offered by the association as false as were those of the earlier settlers? The company's president profited by \$72,005 in contributions

from these working people, promising them that the land, which really was rich, would produce for them the luxuries of wealth within a few years.

The president, Jesse Hazell, is paying for his inhumanity and his crimes by repentance within the walls of the penitentiary. And such an end is too good for such a man. He owned no land in Oregon, yet he sold title to it, and the folks who bought it have lost the savings of their most fruitful years and are back in the harness of toil after vainly watching the bursting of their bubble in the thin air of false hopes.

THE ARMOR PLANT

Thousands of dollars are being spent just now by the Bethlehem Steel company to thwart the congressional plan of establishing a government armor manufacturing plant. Bethlehem steel, with its stock in the sky, can well spend the money it does, but it can ill afford to see the creation of such a federal industry. Probably every newspaper in the United States has received a great deal of literature from the company, and only this week a sixteen-page booklet, setting forth the frightened thoughts of the steel magnates, has been distributed throughout the nation.

To create sympathy the company contends that the armor-plate business has been sadly unprofitable, yet it offers, in view of the recent act of the senate in passing the armor-plate bill, to reduce the price of armor plate to the government from \$425 to \$395 a ton, or to accept any price that the federal trade commission shall deem fair. Surely, Charles M. Schwab and his colleagues have the fear of great loss in their hearts. These many years Schwab and his like have successfully bled the government treasury and have usually been able to control things pretty much to suit themselves. But it comes to pass that the government is, for the most part, in the hands of men who do not see as Schwab does, and they refuse to be led by his will.

"We are urging no plan of preparedness. We have advocated no policy involving increased expenditures by the government for any purpose," says the frank Mr. Schwab. "We are attempting to show, in the most open manner, that it would be unnecessary and unwise for the nation to spend \$11,000,000 to build a government armor plant, because existing facilities can supply every need, and the government can buy armor at least as cheaply as it can manufacture it for itself."

In so saying Mr. Schwab reveals deceit. He and his class have taxed the nation heavily, extorting cold cash wherever the opportunity is presented, and now that the government refuses longer to sanction such things, Mr. Schwab is greatly stirred. He shows, by his willingness to reduce the price materially, that his profits have been enormous; that the great dividends his company has been paying have been blood money extracted from the taxpayers of the nation, and he now bravely stands forth with an offer to submit to federal investigation as to the new price.

The claim that the new armor price set by the steel company is less than the government could produce the same armor for is probably well founded. But if the government had been making its own armor during the years that Schwab and his companions have been robbing the federal treasury we would today have more money to back the preparedness campaign, and would have more battleships on the seas to protect our citizens from such possible enemies as Japan, whose boats are built with armor of government manufacture.

SUCH MAY COME

A headline tells us that publisher's hear of the scarcity of paper. The question of the moment is: Have the readers of the newspapers, publish-

ed by the men who hear this startling news, heard that such an unprecedented state of affairs is upon the nation? The increase in circulation of newspapers, without a corresponding increase of supply, are causes of the scarcity. Publishers have been asked to be as saving as possible and to hoard the scraps as they would so much gold dust.

But, going back, have the readers heard this news? Of course, the publisher will starve to death, along with the shop devil and the office cat, if the supply of paper becomes exhausted. When he's dead and buried, where the dreams of the awful catastrophe are mere history to his sleeping mind, that's all that can befall the luckless man. Those who were readers of his paper live on, in a world where source is less important than gain; where supply is always secondary to demand.

When, if ever, such a dire state of affairs comes upon readers the publisher, who had often stood bravely before the bantering attacks of an ever-bantering public; who had smiled in the face of every calamity; changed sad news to glad and scandal to praise, will roll over in his mossy vault and say: "I told you so."

Verily, the dear publisher will have a right to his words. Through long and sometimes suffering years he had been brave on the battlefield, discharging from his squeaking presses the supply for the public demand. He had told you of the wars and the crimes, the pestilence and the liberations of many years. He had told you of the death of Mrs. Jones, the arrival of Mrs. Smith and the departure of Mrs. Brown, times without number, and finally, with one last bold flourish of an every-ready pen, he had told you of the scarcity of

is behind the president, heart and mind.

When it comes to a crisis in national affairs there is no middle course for true Americans. There is no neutrality. Party politics are gone and forgotten in the shadow of events that cannot be regulated from the seat of government, no matter who draws the presidential salary. When Germany, England or Mexico steps upon the corns of the United States and the president of the nation takes the careless one to task he has a nation behind him to a man.

Surely the great "Bill" Bryan had in mind such times as these when he said something about raising a million men between night and morning, if they were demaded by conditions. There are nearly 90,000,000 patriots in the United States. Not one of that number, deserving a better fate than death at the stake, would forsake the president or the flag in time of need.

Certainly the press and the nation it represents is behind Woodrow Wilson. So long as that great statesman steers the ship of state into channels of honor and humanity, as he has so faithfully done and will continue to do, the press and the nation will stay behind him. And so long as such conditions maintain "fair play, right understanding and the peace, prosperity and glory of America" will be assured.

RABID REPUBLICANISM

Our enterprising contemporary, whose den is the only home hereabouts of that particularly rabid form of republicanism that represents the democratic administration as all conceivable forms of worthlessness, carried a cartoon on the front page of its Saturday morning edition that is

Obituaries

Edward Hughes

At the home of his daughter, Mrs. Anna Spence, Edward Hughes passed away early Friday morning, aged 86 years. Mr. Spence came to America from his birthplace at Caemasthen, Wales, when he was only ten years old. His family settled in Wisconsin where Mr. Hughes married Miss Margaret Davies in 1857. Mrs. Hughes preceded her husband to the grave by more than eighteen years.

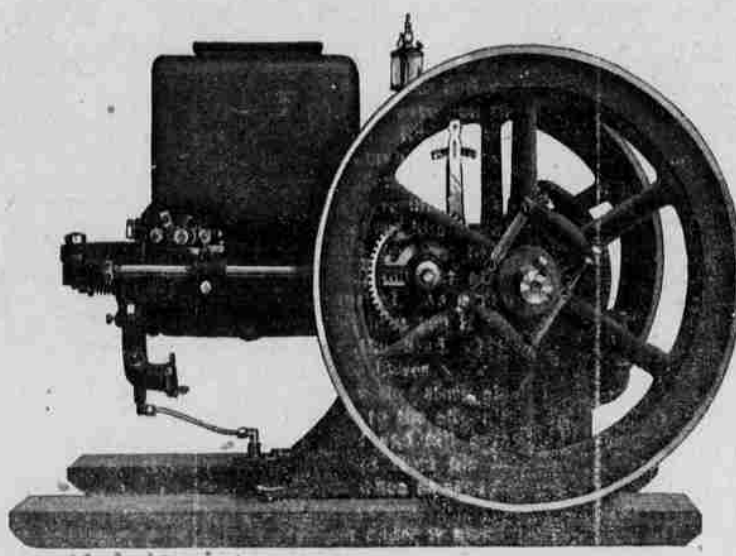
Mr. and Mrs. Hughes and children came to Oregon in 1876 and made their home until their death at Beaver Creek, where Mr. Hughes was buried Sunday in the Presbyterian cemetery. Mr. Hughes leaves one son, Henry W. Hughes, of Oregon City, and two daughters, Mrs. Anna Spence, Oregon City, and Mrs. Mary Grisenthwaite, Oregon City, R. F. D.

Elisha Adamson

Elisha Adamson died early Friday morning at the home of his son, A. W. Adamson at Willamette, as a result of a recent paralytic stroke.

Deceased was born in Indiana in 1842 and had lived in Oregon City for fourteen years. For more than fifty years Mr. Adamson was a member of the Odd Fellows, and this lodge had charge of the burial services which were held at Harrisburg.

Two daughters and three sons are left to mourn the death of their father. They are Mrs. O. L. Smith of Ontario, and Mrs. Jessie Wasson of Harrisburg, and David Adamson, Edward Adamson and A. W. Adamson.



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Mrs. Thomas Ryan, of Salem, had not seen their brother for twenty years before the time he walked up to the door of the Noble home last Saturday. He formerly lived here and was a son of the late Mr. and Mrs. Andrew J. Marshall. Mr. Marshall was born in Oregon City on November 11, 1859, and with his parents moved to Portland several years later. There he had been employed by various firms and several years ago moved to Cody, Wyo., where he remained until he developed the ailment that proved fatal to him here this week.

Two brothers, John and Edward Marshall, live at Greenhorn, Idaho.

Because of the illness of Mrs. Thomas F. Ryan the funeral services were private and interment was made in Lone Fir cemetery at Portland.

EXCHANGES EXEMPT

Industrial Welfare Commission Rules for Continued Service

Telephone exchanges outside of Portland and hotels in all parts of the state, including Portland, will be exempted from the one-day's rest-in-seven rule applying to women workers in other industries of Oregon.

This conclusion was reached on Tuesday by the revision committee of the Industrial Welfare commission, in session at Portland, after listening to testimony from hotel men and telephone managers from various parts of the state.

The session was called primarily to consider those two activities, but time permitted a review of all the recommendations informally made by the committee heretofore.

Camas Mill Workers Strike

A message telling of a labor strike at the Crown-Willamette mills at Camas, Wash., was received at the local plant on Tuesday.

According to the report the force of 80 workmen walked out after demanding an increase of 50 cents a day in pay. Manager Lewthwaite is not at Camas and the trouble will

probably not be settled until he returns.

The strike effected only the finishing room of the mills in the beginning, but other departments are closing out of sympathy for the strikers and a total suspension of operations may result.

Examinations Being Held

The annual eighth grade examinations are to be held in the schools of the county today and tomorrow, and for the purpose County School Superintendent Calavan has sent out questions to the many school districts. Nearly 400 pupils will participate in the examinations, according to an estimate made by the county superintendent. The Oregon City schools are not included in this examination.

Exchange

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You can get the Courier for one year for \$1.00—if you pay in advance.

OLDER BUT STRONGER

To be healthy at seventy, prepare at forty, is sound advice, because in the strength of middle life we too often forget that neglected colds, or careless treatment of slight aches and pains, simply undermine strength and bring chronic weakness for later years.

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2:30 P.M.	2:20 P.M.
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to everything else in the minds of the officers and directors of this bank is the safety of money deposited here and preparedness for its ultimate return to depositors.

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BACKING WILSON

At a big gathering of prominent Americans last week the glad tidings that the press of the nation was behind President Wilson was offered, and imparted to the world through said press.

That sounds a good deal like the information contained in a recent resolution asking the belligerent monarchs to stop the European slaughter, passed at a session of the Ladylike Order for the Restoration of Cheese to Ensnared Mice. Of course, the press of the nation is behind the president. Not only that, but every man, woman and child in these great United States who is entitled to the honor that is bestowed upon him by designation as an American citizen,

most certainly criminal libel, issuing, as it did, from the aforementioned den of rabid republicanism.

Party politics is a mere formality to the great mass of common people, yet certain party organs are forever doing their utmost to discredit the party at present in power. Therefore, it is hugely amusing to notice the reversal of form that overtook The Enterprise on Saturday.

The Courier—\$1.00 per year.

Hiram A. Pendergast

Hiram A. Pendergast, a veteran of the civil war, died at his home at Willamette on Tuesday after suffering for several years with bright's disease.

As a Union soldier Mr. Pendergast served three years and three months in the civil war as a member of Company A, 37th Indiana Infantry, and at the time of his death was an active member of Meade post, No. 2, G. A. R. He was also an active worker in the Methodist Episcopal church.

On February 19, 1869, Mr. Pendergast was married to Eliza Belle Bailey. Mrs. Pendergast died about twenty-two years ago. A daughter and one son survive. They are: Mrs. Harry Morrell of Willamette, and Lew Pendergast of Osgood, Ind.

Mrs. Noble and another sister,